



CITY OF SOUTH MILWAUKEE CIVIC GRANTS COMMISSION MEETING MINUTES

March 19, 2026

1. Call to order.

The meeting was called to order at 5:00 PM. Members present: Melissa Ellis, Ericka Lang, Aleta Schilling and Ald. David Bartoshevich. Dave Kieck was absent.

2. Approval of May 7, 2025 minutes.

Ellis motioned to approve the meeting minutes, seconded by Bartoshevich. Vote unanimous.

3. Update on 2025 Bucyrus Civic Grant recipients.

Lang reviewed the list of 2025 grant recipients. To date, three of the six completed their projects and provided financial reports. Grant funds require use by May 31, 2026 unless an extension was granted. Reports will be provided to commissioners at the next meeting.

4. Consideration of eligible nonprofit requests to apply for 2026 Bucyrus Civic Grant funding.

Commissioners reviewed six Letters of Interests:

The local nonprofit Growing South Milwaukee's ArtWorks requests \$15,000: \$10,000 to hire a professional grant writer for finding funds for future murals and \$5,000 to hire for professional services to market the murals and create a walking tour and other promotions.

Commissioners agreed both items meet eligibility criteria and request clear deliverables with the application.

The South Milwaukee Bucyrus Museum requests \$3,730: \$2,460 for a laptop and Microsoft license to host data to digitally display Bucyrus employee archives and publications for the public to access and \$1,270 to replace storage shelving with a type that allows more storage.

Commissioners agreed a new laptop dedicated to a new display for public access to archived materials is an improvement and eligible. The request for replacing the existing storage racks with eight new racks is considered maintenance and not eligible for the grant.

The **Friends of the South Milwaukee Public Library** requests \$6,000 to create a household tool lending library providing household, specialty tools and equipment located within the library. Funds are for purchasing the equipment and a storage system.

Commissioners agreed the new program meets grant program criteria.

The **South Milwaukee Historical Society** requests \$8,370 for various items:

\$240	Purchase (6) fireproof storage boxes w/ acid-free portfolios
\$3,500	Purchase fireproof 2-drawer lateral filing cabinet
\$270	Purchase microphone, halo light and video creation software
\$4,360	Purchase (2) 36"x24" Gaylord horizontal flat files and base

Commissioners discussed the three storage items and determined the items are considered general operating expenses and not eligible. Commissioners agreed storage equipment is not eligible. New equipment and supply requests require a list of existing items.

Commissioners agreed the microphone and video software meet eligibility requirements.

The **South Milwaukee Police Department** request \$3,500 to create a Ring Doorbell Camera Program and purchase 50 cameras to distribute in the community.

Commissioners agreed the program is eligible and request information about eligibility, subscription costs and access and process of accessing existing cameras.

First Responders Children's Foundation in partnership with local business ServPro request funds to create a specific fund to support a scholarship for a local student who lost a parent during the line of duty.

Commissioners agreed a local scholarship is fundraising and a form of sponsorship that does not meet eligibility criteria. It was also agreed nonprofits outside of the community are eligible to received funds if the funds are spent directly to benefit South Milwaukee.

5. Schedule next meeting.

The next meeting to review grant applications is Thursday May 21st at 5:00 PM.

6. Adjourn.

Schilling motioned to adjourn the meeting at 6:04 PM, seconded by Ellis. Vote unanimous.

Recorded by,

Ericka Lang
Economic Development Manager